FORGE

PHASE 1: FOUNDATION

Know Yourself

Participant Workbook

Weeks 1 – 12

Dooly State Prison

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Week 1 — Identity & Purpose

Who am I, and why am I here?

My FORGE Commitment

By signing below, I commit to full participation in the FORGE program. I understand that my growth depends on my honesty, effort, and willingness to change.

I commit to:

- Attending every session, on time and prepared
- Being honest with myself and my cohort
- Practicing the skills I learn, even when it is hard
- Holding myself and my peers accountable
- Completing all assignments and reflections

_____
Participant Name (printed)

_____
Participant Signature & Date

_____
Facilitator Signature & Date

One Thing I Want to Be Different in 9 Months

Think carefully. What is the single most important change you want to see in yourself by the end of this program?

_____

_____

_____

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My Elevator Speech

An elevator speech is a 30-second introduction that tells people who you are and where you are headed. Use the template below to draft yours.

My name is

Before FORGE, I was known for

What I am working on changing is

By the end of this program, I want to be

One thing you should know about me is

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Week 2 — Thinking Patterns

How my thoughts drive my behavior

The 8 Thinking Errors

Thinking Error	Definition
1. Closed Thinking	Refusing to consider another person's perspective or new information. "I already know everything I need to know."
2. Victim Stance	Blaming others and seeing yourself as the victim in every situation. "This always happens to me."
3. Lack of Empathy	Failing to consider or care about how your actions affect others.
4. Minimizing	Making your harmful behavior seem less serious than it really is. "It wasn't that big a deal."
5. Power Thrust	Using aggression, intimidation, or control to get what you want.
6. Entitlement	Believing you deserve special treatment or that rules don't apply to you.
7. Cognitive Indolence	Taking the easy way out; refusing to think things through.
8. Discontinuity	Starting something and not following through; inconsistency between words and actions.

Thinking Report

Use this 5-column format to break down situations where your thinking led to problems. Fill one out each time you notice a thinking error this week.

Situation	Thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

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Situation	Thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

Thinking Report (continued)

Situation	Thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

Thinking Report (continued)

Situation	Thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

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Situation	Thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

Thinking Report (continued)

Situation	Thought	Feeling	Action	Consequence

STOP Technique

1. **S — Stop.** Freeze. Do not react.
2. **T — Think.** What is my thinking error right now?
3. **O — Options.** What are my choices? What are the consequences of each?
4. **P — Plan.** Choose the best option and act on it.

Alternative Thought Bank

When you catch a thinking error, challenge it and replace it with a healthier thought.

Old Thought	Challenge Questions	New Thought

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Old Thought	Challenge Questions	New Thought

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Week 3 — Emotional Awareness

Understanding what I feel and why

Emotion Wheel Reference

Primary Emotion	Secondary Emotions
Anger	Frustrated, Irritated, Resentful, Hostile
Fear	Anxious, Insecure, Overwhelmed, Panicked
Sadness	Lonely, Hopeless, Disappointed, Grieving
Joy	Grateful, Proud, Content, Excited
Surprise	Confused, Amazed, Shocked, Stunned
Disgust	Contempt, Revolted, Judgmental, Disapproving

Body Map

Draw or label where you feel different emotions in your body.

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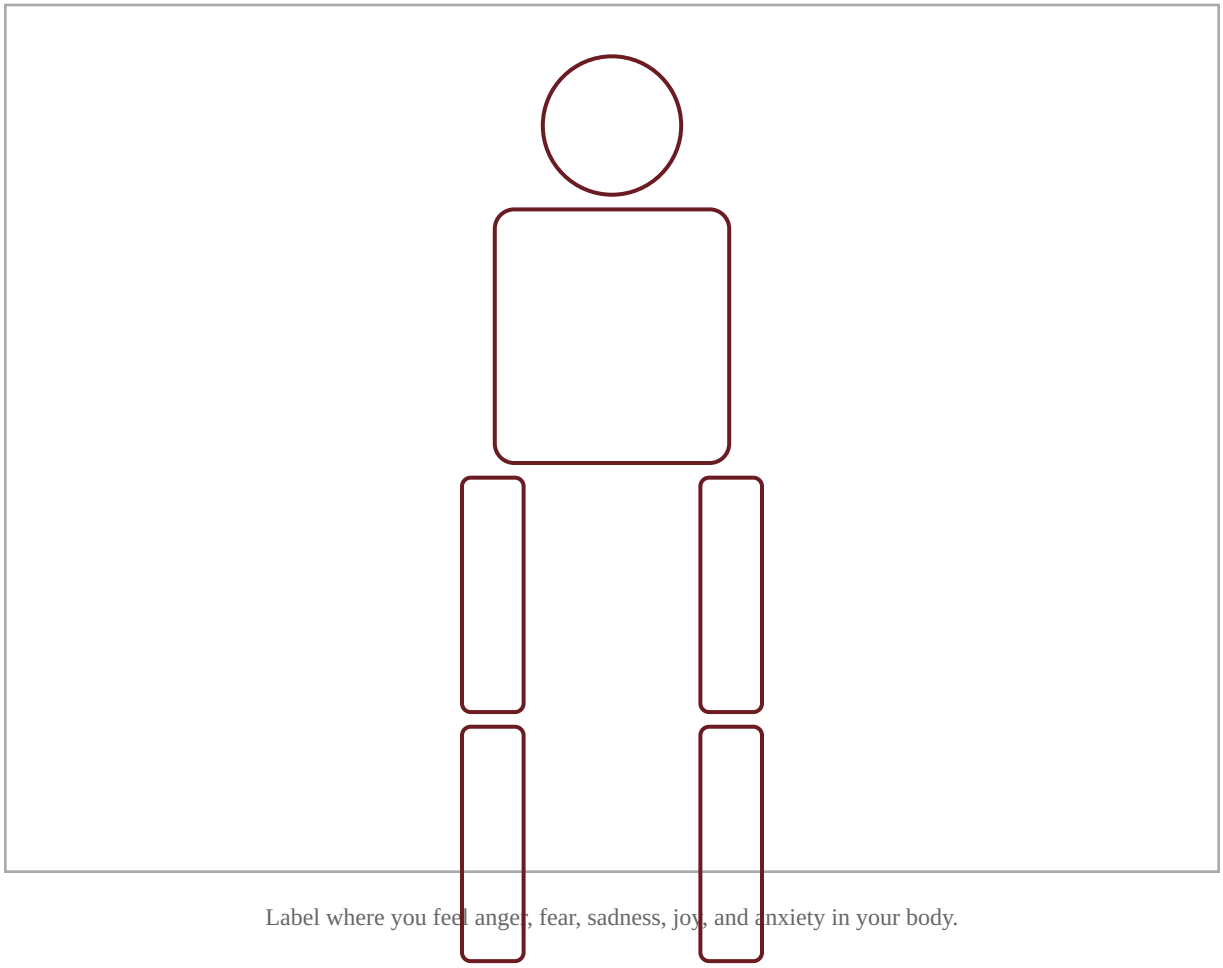

Label where you feel anger, fear, sadness, joy, and anxiety in your body.

Emotion Tracking Log

Record your emotions three times per day for one week.

Date	Time	Emotion	Body Signal	Trigger

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Date	Time	Emotion	Body Signal	Trigger

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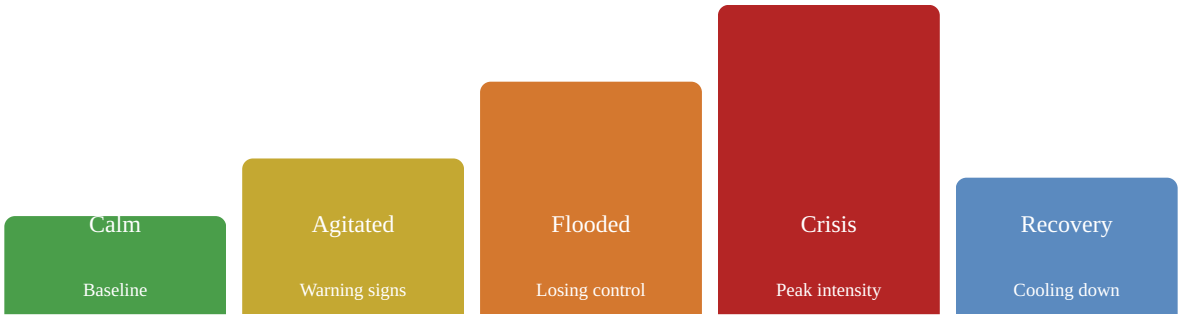
Date	Time	Emotion	Body Signal	Trigger

Escalation Curve

Understanding how emotional intensity builds helps you intervene early.



Key: The goal is to intervene at the *Agitated* stage, before you become *Flooded*. Use your breathing and grounding techniques here.

4-4-4 Breathing Technique

1. **Inhale** slowly through your nose for **4 seconds**.
2. **Hold** your breath for **4 seconds**.
3. **Exhale** slowly through your mouth for **4 seconds**.

Repeat 4 times. This activates your parasympathetic nervous system and lowers your heart rate.

5-4-3-2-1 Grounding Technique

When you feel overwhelmed, name:

- **5** things you can **see**
- **4** things you can **touch**
- **3** things you can **hear**
- **2** things you can **smell**

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- **1** thing you can **taste**

Beneath My Anger — Writing Exercise

When I feel angry, the emotion underneath is usually...

I learned to use anger as a shield because...

The last time I got angry, what I was really feeling was...

If I could express what is beneath my anger without fear, I would say...

The hurt I am protecting with my anger is...

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Week 4 — Coping & Safety

Building my emotional toolkit

Safe vs. Unsafe Coping Strategies

Safe Coping Strategies	Unsafe Coping Strategies
Deep breathing / 4-4-4 technique	Substance use
Physical exercise (push-ups, walking)	Isolation / shutting everyone out
Talking to a trusted person	Physical aggression
Writing in a journal	Verbal intimidation
Listening to calming music	Self-harm
Praying or meditating	Reckless behavior
5-4-3-2-1 grounding	Manipulation
Counting down from 20	Denial / pretending everything is fine
Removing yourself from the situation	Suppressing all emotion
Reading	Blaming others

My Personal Safety Plan

5 safe coping strategies I will use:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

2 people I can talk to when I am struggling:

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1.

2.

1 place where I feel safe:

Journal Prompt

How has my past shaped my present?

Consider: What experiences made you who you are today? Which patterns from your past do you want to break? What strengths has your past given you? *(continue on your own paper)*

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Week 5 — Communication Skills

Listening to understand, speaking to connect

Active Listening — 5 Components

1. **Attending** — Face the speaker, make eye contact, open posture, minimize distractions.
2. **Reflecting** — Mirror back what you hear. "It sounds like you are saying..."
3. **Clarifying** — Ask questions to make sure you understand. "Can you tell me more about...?"
4. **Summarizing** — Recap the main points. "So what I am hearing is..."
5. **Validating** — Acknowledge the speaker's feelings. "That makes sense because..."

"I" Statement Practice Sheet

Rewrite each aggressive statement as an assertive "I" statement using the format: *"I feel [emotion] when [behavior] because [impact]. I need [request]."*

1. Aggressive: "You never listen to me! You don't care about anyone but yourself."

Assertive rewrite:

_____

_____

2. Aggressive: "You're always disrespecting me in front of everyone."

Assertive rewrite:

_____

_____

3. Aggressive: "You took my stuff without asking again. I'm sick of it."

Assertive rewrite:

_____

_____

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4. Aggressive: "You think you're better than me."

Assertive rewrite:

5. Aggressive: "Mind your own business. Nobody asked you."

Assertive rewrite:

SBI Feedback Model

- **S — Situation:** Describe when and where the behavior occurred.
- **B — Behavior:** Describe the specific observable behavior (no judgments).
- **I — Impact:** Describe the effect the behavior had on you or others.

SBI Practice Sheet

Scenario 1

Situation:

Behavior:

Impact:

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Scenario 2

Situation:

Behavior:

Impact:

Scenario 3

Situation:

Behavior:

Impact:

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Week 6 — Conflict Resolution

Turning conflict into connection

FORGE Conflict Resolution Model

1. **Pause & Posture** — Stop. Take a breath. Adopt an open, non-threatening body posture.
2. **Name the Heat** — Identify your emotion and rate it on the Heat Scale (1-10).
3. **Facts > Stories** — Separate what actually happened from the story you are telling yourself.
4. **Needs & Options** — What does each person need? Brainstorm options together.
5. **Agreement & Check-Back** — Agree on a plan and set a time to check back.

Heat Scale (1-10)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

1-3: Calm, can think clearly | **4-6:** Agitated, need to use tools | **7-10:** Flooded, must remove yourself first

Scenario Rating Exercise

Rate each scenario on the Heat Scale and write what you would do.

1. Someone cuts in front of you in the chow line.

Heat level: _____ My response:

_____

_____

2. Your cellmate makes a disrespectful comment about your family.

Heat level: _____ My response:

_____

_____

3. You find out someone has been spreading rumors about you.

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Heat level: _____ My response:

4. A CO speaks to you in a way you feel is demeaning.

Heat level: _____ My response:

Mediation Ground Rules Template

When mediating a conflict between two parties, both parties agree to:

☐ Speak one at a time without interrupting
☐ Use "I" statements instead of "you" accusations
☐ Stay focused on the current issue, not past grievances
☐ Listen to understand, not to respond
☐ Commit to finding a solution, not winning
☐ Keep what is said in mediation confidential
☐ Follow through on agreements made

Additional ground rules for this mediation:

Party 1 Signature & Date

Party 2 Signature & Date

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Mediator Signature & Date

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Week 7 — Accountability

Owning my choices and their impact

Accountability Spectrum

Stage	What It Sounds Like	Level
Denial	"I didn't do anything wrong."	Lowest
Minimization	"It wasn't that serious."	Low
Blame-shifting	"They made me do it."	Mid-Low
Partial Ownership	"I played a part, but..."	Mid-High
Full Accountability	"I chose to do this. I am responsible for the harm."	Highest

My Accountability Statement

Write your accountability statement below. Be specific. Name what you did, who was harmed, and what you are doing to make it right. This is for you — be honest. *(continue on your own paper)*

The 4 Integrity Tests

1. **The Mirror Test** — Can I look at myself in the mirror after this decision?
2. **The Mentor Test** — What would someone I respect think of this choice?
3. **The Front Page Test** — Would I be comfortable if this was on the front page of a newspaper?
4. **The Child Test** — Would I want a child I care about to make this same decision?

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Impact Awareness Letter

This letter is not to send. It is for your own growth. Write to someone you have harmed, addressing these guided prompts:

What I did:

How I think it affected you:

What I wish I had done instead:

What I am doing now to change:

What I want you to know:

(continue on your own paper)

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Week 8 — Empathy & Relationships

Seeing through others' eyes

Perspective-Taking Exercise

Scenario: A man in your housing unit has been disrespectful to several people. One day he gets into a heated argument with another resident and a CO intervenes, writing both of them up. The man who started it claims the other person was the aggressor.

Viewpoint 1 — The man who started the argument:

Viewpoint 2 — The other resident:

Viewpoint 3 — The CO:

Viewpoint 4 — A bystander who saw everything:

Relationship Map

Map your relationships using the concentric circles below. Place people closest to you in the center ring. In the outer rings, place people you interact with but are less close to. Mark each person with **(+)** if they are pro-social or **(−)** if they pull you backward.

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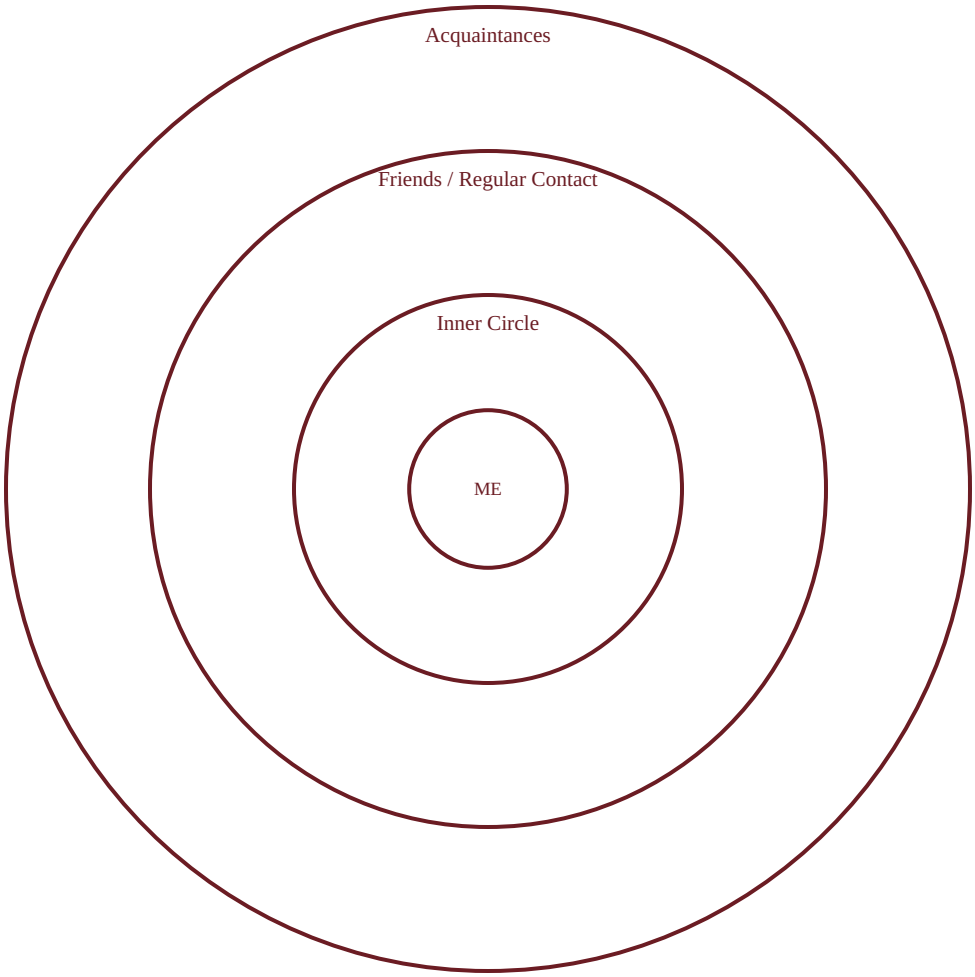

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Week 9 — Decision-Making

Thinking before acting

6-Step Problem Solving

1. **Define the problem** — What exactly is the problem? Be specific.
2. **Gather information** — What do I know? What do I need to find out?
3. **Generate options** — List at least 3 possible solutions.
4. **Evaluate options** — What are the pros and cons of each?
5. **Choose and act** — Pick the best option and commit to it.
6. **Review results** — Did it work? What would I do differently?

Problem-Solving Worksheet

Step 1 — Define the problem:

Step 2 — What I know / need to find out:

Step 3 — My options:

Option A:

Option B:

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Option C:

Step 4 — Pros and cons:

Option	Pros	Cons

Step 5 — My decision and action plan:

Step 6 — Review (fill in after taking action):

My Personal Rules

Personal rules are commitments you make to yourself in advance so you do not have to decide in the moment.

I will always...

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I will never...

Ripple Effect Map

Place a decision in the center circle. In each expanding ring, write the consequences that ripple outward — to yourself, your family, your community, and beyond.

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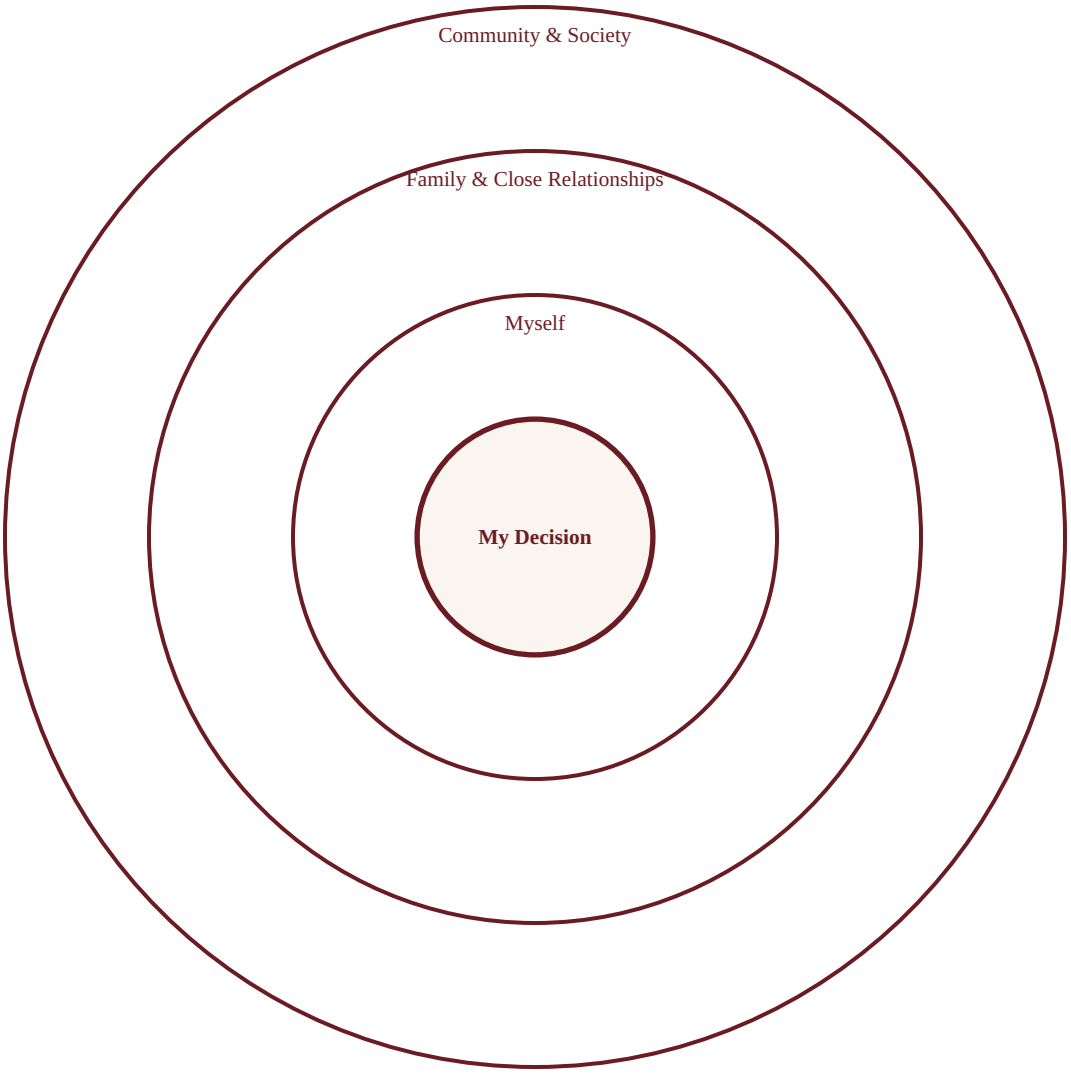

The 10-10-10 Rule

Before making a decision, ask yourself:

- How will I feel about this in **10 minutes**?
- How will I feel about this in **10 months**?
- How will I feel about this in **10 years**?

If the answer changes over time, slow down and think it through.

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Week 10 — Mindset & Vision

Growing from who I was into who I can be

Fixed vs. Growth Mindset

Fixed Mindset	Growth Mindset
"I'm not smart enough."	"I can learn this with effort."
"I failed, so I'm a failure."	"I failed, so now I know what to do differently."
"This is just who I am."	"I can change with practice."
"I don't like being challenged."	"Challenges help me grow."
"Other people's success threatens me."	"Other people's success inspires me."
"Feedback is a personal attack."	"Feedback is information I can use."
"I give up when it's hard."	"I push through when it's hard."
"My past defines me."	"My past informs me; my choices define me."

Letter From My Future Self

Imagine it is two years from now. You have completed FORGE, demonstrated real change, and are building the life you want. Write a letter from that future version of yourself to the person you are today.

What would your future self say about the journey? What advice would they give? What would they want you to know about the hard days ahead? *(continue on your own paper)*

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My Stakeholder Commitment

Identify 5 specific actions you will take to demonstrate your growth to the people who matter.

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

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Week 11 — Self-Assessment & Review

Measuring my growth

Who I Was When I Started and Who I Am Now

Reflect honestly on your journey through Phase 1. How have you changed? What surprised you? Where do you still need to grow? *(continue on your own paper)*

Phase 1 Skills Self-Assessment

Rate yourself on each skill: **1** = Cannot do it yet | **2** = Need more practice | **3** = Can do it with support | **4** = Can do it independently

Skill	1	2	3	4
Identifying my thinking errors				
Using the STOP Technique				
Completing a Thinking Report				
Naming and describing my emotions accurately				
Using 4-4-4 breathing when escalated				
Using 5-4-3-2-1 grounding when overwhelmed				
Recognizing my escalation curve warning signs				
Using safe coping strategies				
Active listening (all 5 components)				
Communicating with 'I' statements				
Giving SBI feedback				

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Skill	1	2	3	4
Using the FORGE Conflict Resolution Model				
Rating myself on the Heat Scale				
Taking full accountability for my actions				
Applying the 4 Integrity Tests				
Writing an impact awareness letter				
Perspective-taking (seeing other viewpoints)				
Mapping my relationships				
Using the 6-Step Problem Solving process				
Applying the 10-10-10 Rule				
Demonstrating a growth mindset				
Articulating my vision for the future				

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Week 12 — Portfolio & Preparation

Completing Phase 1 and preparing for Phase 2

Phase 1 Portfolio Checklist

Check off each item as you confirm it is complete and included in your portfolio.

☐ Signed FORGE Commitment (Week 1)

☐ Elevator Speech — final version (Week 1)

☐ At least 6 completed Thinking Reports (Week 2)

☐ Alternative Thought Bank with at least 5 entries (Week 2)

☐ Completed Emotion Tracking Log (Week 3)

☐ "Beneath My Anger" writing exercise (Week 3)

☐ Personal Safety Plan (Week 4)

☐ Journal: "How has my past shaped my present?" (Week 4)

☐ 5 completed "I" Statement rewrites (Week 5)

☐ 3 completed SBI practice forms (Week 5)

☐ Heat Scale scenario exercise (Week 6)

☐ Accountability Statement (Week 7)

☐ Impact Awareness Letter (Week 7)

☐ Perspective-Taking exercise (Week 8)

☐ Relationship Map (Week 8)

☐ Completed Problem-Solving Worksheet (Week 9)

☐ Personal Rules (Week 9)

☐ "Letter From My Future Self" (Week 10)

☐ Stakeholder Commitment (Week 10)

☐ Self-Assessment reflection (Week 11)

☐ Skills Self-Assessment (Week 11)

☐ Phase 1 Study Guide — reviewed (Week 12)

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Phase 1 Study Guide

Review the key concepts from each week before your Phase 1 assessment.

Week	Key Concepts
Week 1	Identity, purpose, commitment, elevator speech
Week 2	8 Thinking Errors, Thinking Reports, STOP Technique, Alternative Thought Bank
Week 3	Emotion Wheel, body signals, Escalation Curve, 4-4-4 Breathing, 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding
Week 4	Safe vs. unsafe coping, Personal Safety Plan, self-reflection
Week 5	Active Listening (5 components), "I" Statements, SBI Feedback Model
Week 6	FORGE Conflict Resolution Model (5 steps), Heat Scale, mediation ground rules
Week 7	Accountability Spectrum, 4 Integrity Tests, Impact Awareness
Week 8	Perspective-taking, empathy, Relationship Mapping
Week 9	6-Step Problem Solving, Personal Rules, Ripple Effect, 10-10-10 Rule
Week 10	Fixed vs. Growth Mindset, future visioning, Stakeholder Commitment
Week 11	Self-assessment, skills review, growth reflection
Week 12	Portfolio completion, study guide review, readiness for Phase 2

Congratulations on completing Phase 1: Know Yourself.

Your journey continues in Phase 2: Build Others.

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